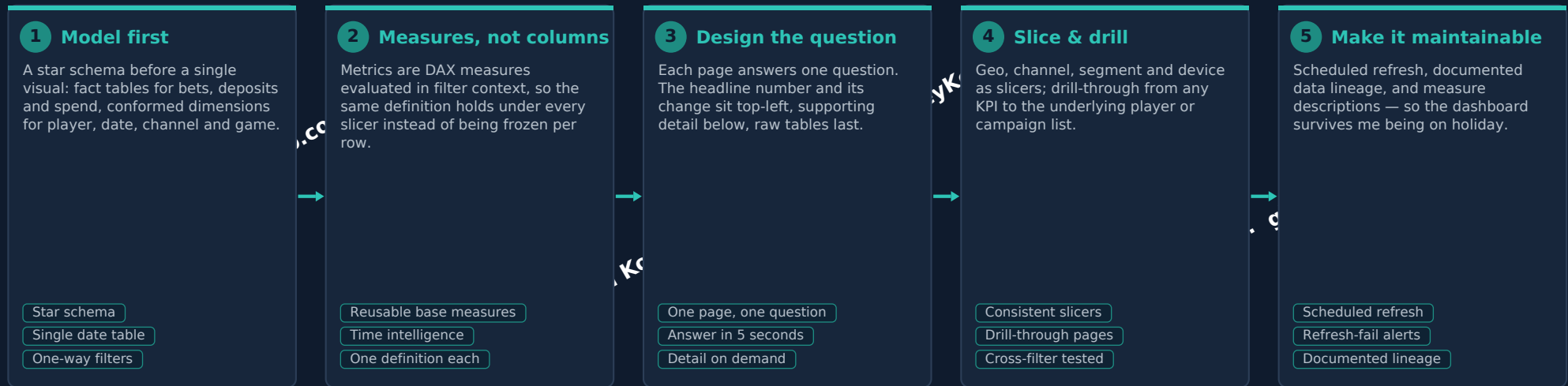


Visualisation — building a dashboard people actually make decisions with

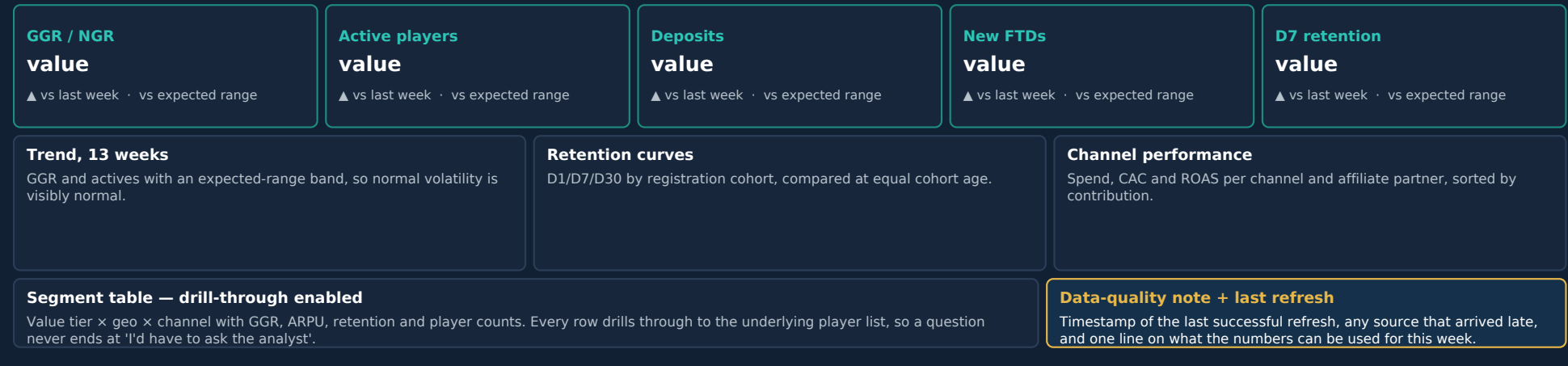
1 / 2

Step 5 of the weekly workflow: from a star-schema model and DAX measures to a layout that answers the question in the first five seconds



Page layout — the weekly overview, read top-left to bottom-right

Reading order is designed, not accidental: the answer first, the explanation next, the evidence last. Anything a stakeholder has to hunt for will not be used.



If a stakeholder needs the analyst present to interpret the dashboard, the dashboard is not finished.

Data Analytics in iGaming, 1926

Model, measures and the design rules behind the visuals

What sits under the dashboard, and the choices that decide whether it gets used after week one

Model & DAX practices

- **Star schema, no snowflakes**

Facts for bets, deposits, bonuses and ad spend; conformed dimensions for player, date, channel, game and geo. Flat models are faster and far easier to hand over.

- **One marked date table**

A single date dimension marked as such, covering full years. Without it, every time-intelligence measure silently returns something plausible and wrong.

- **Base measures, then variants**

Deposits, GGR and NGR defined once; week-over-week, prior period and share-of-total built on top with CALCULATE rather than copied and edited.

- **Explicit measures only**

No implicit aggregation by dragging a column onto a visual — every number on the page traces back to a named measure with a description.

- **Filter direction under control**

One-way filters by default; bidirectional relationships only where a specific need is proven, because they quietly change totals elsewhere.

- **Aggregate at the right grain**

Player-day and campaign-day aggregate tables behind heavy visuals, with detail reachable through drill-through instead of loaded up front.

- **Incremental refresh**

History partitioned and refreshed incrementally; only the restatement window is re-processed, so refresh stays minutes rather than hours.

- **Row-level security where needed**

Affiliate managers see their own partners, country teams their own markets — the same report, scoped per role.

- **Multi-currency handled in the model**

Conversion applied at load against a rate dimension, with the original currency retained, so a EUR view and a local view come from one model.

- **Performance budget per page**

Visual count and query timings checked before release; a page that takes ten seconds to load is a page nobody opens twice.

- **Field parameters for flexibility**

Users switch metric or dimension inside one visual instead of me shipping five near-identical charts.

- **Version control on the model**

Report and model changes tracked, so a definition change can be traced to a date and a reason.

Design rules I hold to

- **A number without a comparison is decoration**

Every KPI carries a prior period and an expected range, or nobody can tell whether it is good.

- **Colour carries meaning, not decoration**

One accent for the primary metric, red and green reserved strictly for direction — never for categories.

- **No pie charts for more than three slices**

Ranked bars are read accurately; pies are not. Share-of-total is a sorted bar with labels.

- **Truncated axes are labelled**

A y-axis that does not start at zero is allowed for trends, but it is stated so a 2% move does not look like a cliff.

- **Fewer visuals, more answer**

If a chart does not change a decision, it is removed. A crowded page is where dashboards go to be ignored.

- **Mobile check before release**

Executives open reports on a phone; the top KPI strip has to survive a narrow screen.

- **Consistent placement across pages**

Slicers and KPI strips sit in the same position everywhere, so navigation costs no attention.

- **Empty states are designed**

A filter combination with no data says so plainly instead of showing a blank rectangle that reads as zero.

Handover — what makes it survive without me

- Measure descriptions written in the model, visible on hover in the report.
- A data dictionary page inside the dashboard: definitions, sources, refresh schedule.
- Refresh failure alerts routed to a person, not to an unread mailbox.
- Version notes when a definition changes, with history restated or explicitly not.
- A short walkthrough recorded once, so new stakeholders onboard without a meeting.
- Access and row-level security reviewed when someone joins or leaves the team.